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India's T20 World Cup triumph in the Caribbean may be less than three months old. But the silverware-drought-ending feat has done little to temper expectations around Rohit Sharma's men, who embark on the home stretch of their World Test Championship (WTC) 2023-25 campaign with a two-match series against Bangladesh.

The format of the WTC, which runs over two years across six series for each of the nine participating sides, has imbued bilateral engagements with jeopardy and consequence.

Even as India's post-T20 World Cup experiments against Zimbabwe and

Sri Lanka flew under the radar, in large part because of the Olympic Games in Paris, the assignment against Bangladesh or the oncoming packed Test season will afford no such leeway.

India will play 10 Test matches, five at home and as many away, over the next four months to consolidate its top position in the WTC standings and march into its third successive final. The upcoming four months will test the skill and fitness of India's finest long-format cricketers, whose last 10 Tests were held over 14 months, starting from the WTC 2023 final defeat to Australia at The Oval.

Though the trial by pace that awaits India Down Under during the Border-Gavaskar Trophy gets top billing, the Bangladesh test at home,

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before the Kiwis come visiting for three matches, will be a handful.

A historic 2-0 series win in Pakistan propped Bangladesh up to the fourth spot in the table, and The Tigers will be borne on that tailwind from Rawalpindi when they dock on the balmy shores of Chennai before moving on to Kanpur.

India has maintained a clean sheet against Bangladesh in Tests, but it came as close as it ever has to conceding that spotless record the last time the two met, back in December 2022 in Mirpur. On a